

strong fonts if needed. Convey emotion by the use of underlining, exclamation marks, vivid backgrounds, and so forth. (But don't get into such a mood too often, or you'll be fired.)

Templates and themes are good

Some situations demand only a modicum of creativity; don't reinvent sliced bread. There are PowerPoint templates for you to use. Check local templates as well as those available for download from Office Online. Templates are made to match certain situations, and if yours is one of those stock situations, go ahead—save some time and use a template. The same goes for themes.

Tip

This is just to emphasise that Themes for PowerPoint available off the Microsoft Office Online Web site are made for specific kinds of presentations, and considerable effort has gone into their creation. Understand what situations they're meant for, and don't customise them, as a rule.

Use the Slide Master

We cannot use a bold font to emphasise this, but we wish we could. There should—at least in most cases—be consistency (whether in formatting, or in amount of content, or almost any other aspect) across your slides. When you format your slides, use the Master. When you rectify something in a slide—such as making the font size a little larger or smaller—do it in the Slide Master so it will reflect across all slides.

Chart or table?

This is best answered by reflecting upon what you want to emphasise, assuming we're talking about data that can be represented both ways. A chart could look silly in some situations—such as when there are too few data points. A table could hamper flow in some situations—as when there's just too much data or too many decimal points (if they must be mentioned for reasons of accuracy). Similarly, a table could be just right in some cases if it is designed well, if it contains the right amount of data, and if important figures or words are highlighted nicely by the use of